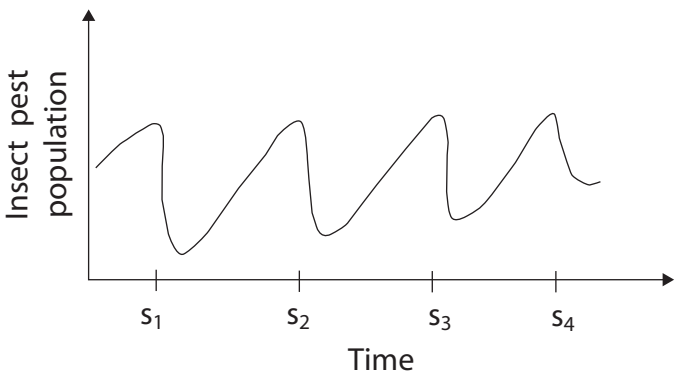
Pesticide resistance

Insect pests, microorganisms and even plants can become **resistant** to specific chemicals if they are over-used. Resistance can be caused by **mutations** in the genetic make-up of individuals.

☞ **1** Add the missing vowels (a, e, i, o, u) to complete the passage below.

Farmers spr__y their crops with **pesticides** to k__ll insect pests. Insects can quickly d__v__l__p resistance to p__st__c__d__s because they lay hundreds of eggs and they have such a sh__rt life span. In any given __ns__ct population a small proportion will have a **genetic** r__s__st__nc__ to a pesticide. After the p__st__c__d__ has been sprayed, m__st insects will die but the resistant ones will live to br__ __d with one another. The next g__n__r__t__ __ n will have a lot of resistant insects so when the f__rm__r sprays the same pesticide it will kill off f__w__r insects. Eventually, over r__p__ __t__d pesticide applications, the majority of the insect p__p__l__t__ __n will be resistant to the chemical.



* where s = spray application

2 Are all the pests killed after the first spray application? _____

_____

3 Why might some pests survive?_____

_____

4 Why do fewer insects die at each subsequent spray?_____

_____

5 How can the farmer better manage the insect population?_____

_____

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